Attachment 2: Instruction and Evaluations

INSTRUCTIONS, CONDITIONS AND NOTICES TO OFFERORS

The source selection methodology to be used will be a Lowest Price Technical Acceptable Source Selection (LPTA). It is with the Government's intent to award a single contract to the Offeror as determined by an integrated assessment of the evaluation criteria established in this Task Order Proposal Request (TOPR) utilizing the fair opportunity basis pursuant to Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 16.505 ordering procedures. The evaluation criteria are divided into two (2) factors: Technical Capability and Price. Technical Capability will be assessed as acceptable or unacceptable based on demonstrated technical approaches as stated in Factor 1 for the technical capability as set forth in the TOPR and Attachment 1, Performance Work Statement (PWS).

The instructions provided specify the format and content that Offerors shall use in response to this TOPR. The intent is not to restrict the Offerors in the manner in which they will perform their work but rather to ensure a certain degree of uniformity in the format of the responses for evaluation purposes. This requirement is being solicited to 8(a) small businesses on the GSA STARS III for vendors assigned to NAICS 541512, Computer Systems Design Services.
Therefore, proposals will only be accepted from offerors who are registered under STARS III 8(a) SB Pool 1.

ONLY THE MINIMUM AMOUNT OF INFORMATION REQUIRED TO PROVIDE FOR PROPER EVALUATION IS REQUESTED. EFFORTS SHOULD BE MADE TO KEEP OFFERS AS CONCISE AS POSSIBLE WITH THE EMPHASIS BEING ON PROVIDING INFORMATION ESSENTIAL FOR PROPER EVALUATION. The proposal shall be clear, concise, and include sufficient detail to provide for adequate evaluation and for substantiation of the validity of stated claims. Submitted documents must contain adequate information to enable the evaluation team to fully ascertain offerors capability to perform contract requirements, must meet the requirements of the TOPR, and must address the evaluation factors for award.

SUBMISSION OF PROPOSALS Proposal Delivery

Instructions

Offerors shall acknowledge awareness of all amendments to the solicitation by signing and dating the proposal and any revisions. Please include name, title, and signature of the individual authorized to sign on behalf of the company.

The Offeror agrees to hold the prices in its offer firm for 180 calendar days from the date final pricing is received by the U.S. Government as specified.

The Offeror shall include two (2) separate volumes in response to the TOPR:

1. Technical Capability – FACTOR 1
2. Price – FACTOR 2

E-mail size shall not exceed 10MB. Multiple e-mails are allowed for proposal package submission. Where multiple e-mails are submitted offerors shall indicate in the subject line how many e-mails are being sent (e.g. 1 of 3, 2 of 3, and 3 of 3). If the Offeror chooses to mail their proposal, an electronic copy must be provided on a CD-ROM. Offerors are advised to strictly comply with all instructions within this solicitation in order to ensure their submission of complete proposals. Failure to furnish a complete proposal at the time of proposal submission may result in the proposal being unacceptable to the Government and eliminated

from consideration for award. The Government will not accept any changes to the Offeror's original proposal after the offer due date for receipt of proposals.

Each e-mailed or mailed proposal shall have the name of the Offeror and the TOPR number in the subject line. Also included is the following information:

- Small Business Status/Categories as appropriate
- Company point of contact with email, phone and facsimile number
- CAGE Code, DUNS number, and Tax ID Number
- A statement that your company understands the requirements specified in the Performance Work
- Statement (PWS) and will meet the performance standards and requirements therein

It is the Offeror's responsibility to ensure that proposals are received by the due date and time required. The Government will acknowledge receipt of all proposals. If an acknowledgement is not received, it is the Offeror's responsibility to follow-up with 772 ESS to guarantee receipt.

The Technical volume shall be in Microsoft Word for Windows (2007 or newer)(.docx), on 8 ½ X 11 inch size, with 1-inch margins all around, Times New Roman font of not less than 10 point font size inclusive of tables, charts, graphs, graphics, etc. Text, tables, charts, graphs, graphics, etc. that are not in compliance will not be considered by the Government in its evaluation. Each page of each document shall have a footer indicating the name of the offeror and "page X of Y."

The total number of the pages submitted for the technical volume shall not exceed 20 single sided pages (8 ½ X 11 inch), excluding a title page and table of contents. If the technical volume contains more than 20 pages, only the first 20 pages will be evaluated. Cover letters are not required; any information contained in a cover letter will not be evaluated. If resumes are included, the documents are excluded from the 20 page limit for the Technical Volume.

Complete Technical and Pricing volumes shall be submitted at the same time via electronic mail (e-mail) to Mark Ingle; mark.ingle.2@us.af.mil & Micheal Grasso; michael.grasso.3@us.af.mil and also through the E-Buy portal.

Proposals are due by 19 February 2026 at 1:00 PM Central Daylight Time. Your package must show the Solicitation Number and the name and address of the Offeror. All proposals must be in English.

Any questions regarding this solicitation shall also be submitted to the above email addresses. Questions should be presented in writing to 772 ESS no later than **09 February 2026 by 1:00 PM Central Daylight Time**. Questions shall be listed chronologically and reference the corresponding solicitation section and paragraph. 772 ESS's responses to questions will be emailed to the STARS III 8(a) Offerors. Any changes to the TOPR or PWS will be issued using an amendment. The source of the questions will not be disclosed.

DISPOSITION OF UNSUCCESSFUL PROPOSALS

In compliance with FAR Subpart 4.8, Government Contract Files, the Government will retain one copy of all unsuccessful proposals. Additional copies of unsuccessful proposals will be destroyed.

TECHNICAL VOLUME – TECHNICAL CAPABILITY - FACTOR 1

Technical Capability Submission Requirements: The Offeror shall provide a technical approach as follows:
a. The technical proposal shall be clear, concise, and include sufficient detail for effective evaluation and for substantiating the validity of stated claims in the Offeror's proposal. Legibility, clarity and coherence are very important. The proposal should not simply rephrase or restate the Government's requirements but rather should provide convincing rationale to address how the Offeror intends to meet these requirements. Statements that the Offeror understands, can, or will comply with the PWS (including referenced publications, technical data, etc.); statements paraphrasing the PWS or parts thereof (including applicable publications, technical data, etc.); and phrases such as "standard procedures will be employed" or "well known techniques will be used," etc., will be considered unacceptable. Offerors assume that the Government has no prior knowledge of their facilities and experience and will base its evaluation on the information presented in the Offeror's proposal. Elaborate brochures or documentation, binding, detailed artwork, or other embellishments are unnecessary and are not desired.

b. The Technical Capability Volume shall, at a minimum, be prepared in a form consistent with the submitted PWS and the evaluation criteria for award set forth in this TOPR within the framework of the Streamlined Technology Acquisition Resource for Services (STARS) III Small Business ordering guide. The section shall be prepared in an orderly format and in sufficient detail to enable the Government to make a thorough evaluation of the Offeror's technical competence and ability to comply with the contract task order requirements specified in the submitted PWS. The Offeror shall address as specifically as possible the actual methodology to be used in accomplishing the proposed PWS tasks. The volume shall be organized according to the following general outline:

- Table of Contents
- List of Table and Drawings (if applicable)
- Evaluation Criteria:
  - Factor 1 – Technical Capability

c. The technical approach will be evaluated for evidence of the degree to which the Offeror demonstrates a clear understanding of the requirements for the Commercial Management Information System (CMIS) requirement as defined in the PWS. Responses should display a reasonable, well-thought-out approach that demonstrates the Offeror's understanding of tasks to be performed, as well as the technical approach and methodology for accomplishing tasks under any resultant award to meet the requirements of the PWS. The technical factor for the evaluation criteria is as follows:

Factor 1 – Technical Capability. Technical Capability for the requirement will be evaluated on whether the proposal clearly demonstrates a clear understanding of the tasks in accordance with the PWS. Technical Capability acceptability in the proposal is met if the following is satisfied:

- The submitted proposal shall establish how the tasks identified in PWS will be accomplished. Tasks should be clearly organized into Configuration, Implementation, and Execution for Part 2 of the PWS as reference in 2.3 through 2.15.
- Explain how the deliverables scheduled for 4.1 of the PWS are to be developed.

d. Technical Capability Rating. Technical Capability Proposals will be given a rating of Acceptable or Unacceptable. The technical evaluations shall utilize the ratings listed in Table 3 below.

Table 3. Technical Ratings	
Rating	**Description**
Acceptable	The proposal meets all the requirements identified in the TOPR. Only those proposals determined acceptable, either initially or as a result of discussions, will be considered for award.
Unacceptable	Fails to meet one or more requirements in the TOPR resulting in an unacceptable rating will not be considered for award.

The rating of the Offeror's Technical Capability will determine whether the Government will consider the Offeror for award. The Government will proceed as follows based on Technical Capability rating:

a. If deemed technically acceptable: Proceed to evaluate Offeror's price.
b. If deemed technically unacceptable: The Offeror's proposal will not be considered for award.

If the Offeror is proposing as a mentor/protégé or business relationship other than subcontracting, the Offeror's technical volume shall clearly detail the nature of the relationship between the parties, (i.e. mentor-protégé, joint venture, subcontractor consent letter, etc.) and address the responsibilities of all parties as they relate to provision of services under the resultant contract.

PRICING VOLUME – PRICE – FACTOR 2

The Offeror should include pricing for each Contract Line-Item Number (CLIN) as listed in the TOPR as follows:

a. Complete the pricing schedule designated as Attachment 3. In doing so, the Offeror accepts the contract terms and conditions as written in the TOPR with attachments. The solicitation constitutes the model contract.

b. Insert the proposed prices for base (12 months) and all option periods in the pricing schedule for each of the CMIS CLINs. Ensure the total extended pricing for each CLIN is calculated correctly.

c. Offers will be evaluated utilizing price analysis techniques (completeness/accuracy; and reasonableness) to determine if the price is complete, reasonable, and balanced. Unreasonably high, unbalanced, inaccurate or incomplete price proposals may be grounds for eliminating a proposal from competition. The Government will evaluate proposed prices for reasonableness using price analysis techniques.

d. Below are the labor classifications for the STARS III 8(a) Small Business contract that the proposed labor occupations for the Full-Time Equivalent (FTE) employee should be mapped to as follows:

Table 4. Labor Classifications

Classifications	STARS III
Junior	Applies fundamental concepts, processes, practices, and procedures on technical assignments. Performs work that requires practical experience and training. Work is performed under supervision.
Journeyman	Possesses and applies expertise on multiple complex work assignments. Assignments may be broad in nature, requiring originality and innovation in determining how to accomplish tasks. Operates with appreciable latitude in developing methodology and presenting solutions to problems. Contributes to deliverables and performance metrics where applicable.

Senior	Possesses and applies comprehensive knowledge across key tasks and high impact assignments. Plans and leads major technology assignments. Evaluates performance results and recommends major changes affecting short-term project growth and success. Functions as a technical expert across multiple project assignments. May supervise others.
Subject Matter Expert (SMEs)	Provides technical/management leadership on major tasks or technology assignments. Establishes goals and plans that meet project objectives. Has domain and expert technical knowledge. Directs and controls activities for a client, having overall responsibility for financial management, methods, and staffing to ensure that technical requirements are met. Interactions involve client negotiations and interfacing with senior management. Decision making and domain knowledge may have a critical impact on overall project implementation. May supervise others.

The Labor Categories (LCATs) for each FTE should closely fall under one of the labor classifications listed above. The available LCATs are listed in Attachment J-2 of the Master 8(a) STARS III contract. The proposed Fully Burdened Rates (FBRs) should not exceed the maximum rates on your awarded STARS III contract.

The evaluation of price will be performed using one or more of the price analysis techniques in accordance with FAR 15.404-1. These pricing techniques are necessary to determine if the price is complete, reasonable, and balanced. Through these techniques, the Government will determine whether the proposed prices are complete, reasonable, and balanced. For additional information see FAR 31.201-3.

(1) Award of a single contract will be made to the Offeror that is deemed technically acceptable with lowest approved pricing.

(2) The Government may determine that an offer is unacceptable if the proposed prices are significantly unbalanced.

(3) Unbalanced Pricing may be evaluated as applicable, to assess potential performance risk which could result in unreasonably high prices.

(4) Definitions.

Completeness/Accuracy. The Offeror's proposal is in compliance with the Price Volume instructions in the solicitation.

Reasonableness. A price is reasonable if, in its nature and amount, it does not exceed that which would be incurred by a prudent person in the conduct of competitive business.

Unbalanced. The price of one or more contract line items is significantly over or understated as indicated by the application of cost or price analysis techniques.

e. Some of these pricing techniques include but are not limited to comparison of the proposed Total Evaluated Price (TEP) with the Independent Government Cost Estimate (IGCE), current contract pricing, and/or comparison of the TEP amongst all technically acceptable Offerors. Through these techniques the Government will determine whether the proposed prices are complete, reasonable, and balanced. After all pricing has been evaluated for reasonableness through the use of price analysis; the TEPs will be ranked from lowest to highest to determine the award.

f. The Government reserves the right to require the submission of Other Than Certified Cost or Pricing Data as is deemed necessary to arrive at a fair and reasonable price.

FINAL PROPOSAL REVISION

The Government intends to make an award based on initial proposals without discussion. However, discussions may be held for only Offerors who are technically acceptable, which could result in a request for a Final Proposal Revision. If it is determined to be in the best interest of the Government to hold discussions, the Government will determine which Offeror's to conduct discussions with. Offerors that engage in such discussions may receive Evaluation Notices (ENs). An EN is issued to the Offeror to clarify or resolve a discrepancy between the proposal and the TOPR. The ENs as well as Final Proposal Revisions will be considered in making the award decision. Offerors should be aware that a complete understanding regarding price, technical approach, and all the terms and conditions of the proposed contract must exist between the Offeror and the Government at the conclusion of the discussions.

Any technical revision or other revision that is not in accordance with contract terms and conditions or in accordance with discussions which are submitted in the Final Proposal Revision may not be subject to further discussion or negotiation and will render the offer unacceptable to the Government. This provision is not intended to restrict the Offeror's opportunity to revise figures (e.g. prices, discounts, percentages, rates, etc.). Rather it is intended to preclude any misunderstandings by the Government which would result if new or revised terms and conditions that have not been fully disclosed, discussed, and understood during discussions or negotiations are submitted in the Final Proposal Revision.